

Tobias Treppmann

A design system that ships as an API, and a build that refuses work which leaves it

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design infrastructure and frontend

Design system as an API: DTCG tokens in four tiers, Style Dictionary, live sync to Figma and Android · one commit propagates to every platform · Storybook as the source of truth · checks in CI that refuse off-system work

AI-enablement in frontend and design

Agentic engineering in production for a year · prototypes in real code against production APIs, web first then Android · Claude Code, Claude skills, Cursor and Zed as daily tools

Craft leadership and visual strategy

Bibel TV's color engine and the tool that configures it, both live · k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB · WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm · Selah, a macOS app shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Leading, and organizational change

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the senior leadership team · the Datameer design team across Germany and NYC for five years · design-system governance as a working group with an escalation path

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has gone into the layer underneath design — systems, tooling, governance. Hands-on, on purpose. It is how you learn what AI is really doing to the craft, and where the opportunity in it is. At Bibel TV it means owning UI quality across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with the standard built into the system, not into my review.

Four tiers

primitives, semantic, component and page/view — one commit reaches Figma, Android and web

Six checks

identical on a laptop and in CI, refusing work that leaves the system

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- A design system the build enforces — checks that run identically locally and in CI over Storybook, refusing work that has left the system, so the standard holds without a reviewer.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens in four tiers, built with Style Dictionary and synced live to Figma and Android.
- A color engine, and the tool that configures it — k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB, so themes carry perceptual weight.
- AI-enablement in frontend, in production for a year — I prototype against real APIs and engineering ships from that code. That engineering is an external agency, so the handoff crosses a company boundary.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Accessibility shipped under regulation, not advocated — AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance, under GDPR plus church data-protection law, across six countries.
- Booking module, the decision I defended through the build — a client-funded project scoped as a standalone add-on, reframed into a platform capability and held to delivery.
- Product management and all of product design at once — priority setting and resource allocation were mine, and I ran the ticket board engineering worked from.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — from July to October 2023 I ran Product Design and Product together as a single domain, covering multiple teams. Senior leadership team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including hiring the consultant who then took Head of Product permanently.
- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder (freelance, summer 2025) — the AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization, and ran the design-thinking training for leadership and service teams.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense enterprise interfaces — pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic.
- Design system — I defined component behavior and specs across the library.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA